

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1136

By Howell

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Richard Taylor for his distinguished career in emergency services and law enforcement.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in recognizing those dedicated public servants who performed with uncommon devotion and enthusiasm in securing the safety of their community; and

WHEREAS, one such estimable individual is Richard Taylor, whose lifelong commitment to public service has benefited the people of Bradley County, Polk County, and the State of Tennessee for more than fifty years; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Taylor began his career in public service in 1977 as a reserve officer with the Cleveland Police Department, demonstrating a sense of duty and responsibility that would define his career; and

WHEREAS, in 1980, he joined the Bradley County Sheriff's Office, where he served with distinction for fourteen years and rose to the position of chief deputy, in which capacity he served from 1990 to 1994; and

WHEREAS, throughout his career, Richard Taylor has been involved in emergency management and disaster response, serving with the Tennessee Emergency Management Hazardous Materials Team, beginning in 1981, and playing an important role in hazardous materials response and training for emergency personnel; and

WHEREAS, in 1982, Mr. Taylor joined the Bradley County Civil Defense Rescue Squad as law enforcement liaison and remains a lifetime member of that organization; and

WHEREAS, Richard Taylor further demonstrated his dedication to emergency preparedness and response through his service as a Tennessee Emergency Management Agency Area Coordinator from 1984 until his retirement in 2014; and

WHEREAS, in addition to these responsibilities, he served as Search and Rescue Coordinator for Polk County Emergency Management and became widely respected for his expertise in search and rescue operations and disaster response; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Taylor, a skilled K-9 handler, trained search and rescue dogs that aided in numerous successful search operations; and

WHEREAS, throughout more than five decades of service, Richard Taylor has mentored countless men and women in emergency services, teaching search and rescue classes, incident command courses, and other training programs that have strengthened emergency response capabilities throughout East Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Taylor's career has been marked by a steadfast commitment to service above self, responding to natural and man-made disasters across Tennessee and mentoring the next generation of first responders while continuing to share his knowledge and experience in the field of emergency services; and

WHEREAS, Richard Taylor exemplifies the spirit and allegiance to family and community that are characteristic of a true Tennessean; and

WHEREAS, throughout his years in public service, Mr. Taylor has demonstrated the utmost professionalism, ability, and integrity, winning the respect and admiration of his fellow officers, emergency responders, and the citizens of this State; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor Richard Taylor for his remarkable career in law enforcement and emergency management and commend him for his lifelong commitment to protecting the citizens of Tennessee.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to

the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.